

THE BOODLEMAN ON HAND.

The Railroad Lobby in Lincoln Reinforced From All Sections of the State.

BATTLING AGAINST THE PEOPLE.

A Conference on the Omaha Charter Results in One Amendment—Doings in Both Branches of the Legislature.

The Railroad Lobby.

LINCOLN, Neb., Feb. 8.—[Special Telegram to the Bee.]—The regular railroad lobby has been reinforced by arrivals from various sections of the state, men who are notoriously in the pay of these corporations. The most numerous delegation came down from Omaha last night. Among these are Bill McHugh, John Smiley, Mike Meaney, Hugh Murphy and his pard. Fanning. Several merchants and capitalists who are closely in business with and especially favored by the railroads have also arrived to exert their influence in conjunction with the railroad lobby in an effort to have the Omaha charter amended and the railroad managers. What their tactics will be has not yet transpired. The regular brass-collared gang are not lagging in the least in their work to defeat the charter. One of the most active of this class is Geo. Crawford, formerly from Omaha and more recently from Idaho. Crawford expended a great deal of wind on a democratic member of the senate last night to convince him that it was his duty to have the Omaha charter amended by the senate. He boasted that he had brought over Vandemark to his own disinterested views, but in vain. The senator blantly told him that he was tired of all such attempts to filibuster, and understood clearly what influences were brought to bear upon Colby to induce him to antagonize the bill in which no member outside of Omaha had the remotest interest.

PROFESSORS OF BUREAUS.

A representative of the Bee was informed to-day by a member of the legislature who has some railroad leaning, in a burst of confidence, that money had been proffered members of the legislature to defeat any railroad legislation, and that there was enough of it to be used at the proper time. Desperate efforts are being made by the railroad managers to prevent the adoption of the railroad commission. Senator Sherrin has been advised that a petition will reach him from Dodge county asking that he change his vote on that issue. These petitions have been set in motion by the Elkhorn Valley railroad emissaries, who threaten the people of Fremont that the promised railroad shops will not be located there and the dire calamity will befall the state if no more railroad legislation in Nebraska if the commission has to go. This threat is not considered very serious, as the device is the old story repeated every time the legislature meets.

Work of the Charter Conference.

LINCOLN, Neb., Feb. 8.—[Special Telegram to the Bee.]—A meeting for conference between Omaha property holders, who came here last night and this morning to secure changes in the charter bill, and the Douglas county legislative delegation was held in the private dining room of the Capital hotel this morning. There were present besides the members of the legislature Ben Gallagher, W. V. Morse, Judge Savage, Hugh Murphy, E. Rosewater, P. E. Her, Henry W. Yates, Charles Green, O. H. Rothacker, F. R. Morrissey, and others. The discussion was opened by a statement by the chairman, W. V. Morse, that the meeting was called for the purpose, if possible, to reconcile the differences regarding the charter and come to an understanding. Judge Savage was called upon and said that the most vital feature of objection in the charter to his mind was the clause relating to municipal taxation of railroad track property. He said that if the clause provided only for the taxation of such railroad property lying outside the right of way, and such property as might encroach upon the right of way not used in actual operation of the roads, the gentlemen who were there to confer with the delegation would not interpose objection. He thought it to be the best interest of Omaha that the ground covered by ties and rails should not be taxed by the city. He intimated that he was one of the members of the legislative delegation that the charter in its present shape does not provide for a tax of this property.

To this Mr. Smyth responded that in so far as he was concerned he was aware that the charter contemplated municipal tax on the tracks as well as all other property, and he believed this was right. At present the valuation of the Union Pacific trackage, as assessed, was \$250,000 when it should properly be assessed \$500,000.

Mr. Andrew said his understanding was that the clause referred to property outside of the right of way.

After considerable discussion at random, during which a suggestion that the Union Pacific would possibly wish to build a \$500,000 depot next year if it would not be taxed was generally smiled at, Mr. Andrew moved that the delegation be allowed to confer alone with Judge Savage as a representative of the citizens committee.

Before the motion was put, Mr. Smyth asked whether, if the delegation should agree to make suitable amendment to the railroad tax clause, the gentlemen of the press, (meaning Morrissey and Rothacker) would then refrain from further opposition to the charter.

Mr. Rothacker replied in substance that in his opinion the tax clause was not the most important and he would not be far from the truth in saying that it was not the most important or one of the most objectionable features. This caused Morrissey to attempt to occupy time in urging his objection to the printing provision. He insisted that it ought to be so worded that the patronage of the printing would go with the political status of the city government. It appeared the legislative delegation did not relish Morrissey's defection from the main issue before the meeting to that it was an important matter in which he, as a representative of the people, apparently had only a narrowly selfish interest, as several of them put on their hats and coats.

Andrew's motion was put and carried. Almost as soon as Morrissey, Rothacker and others, who had but little earnest interest in the meeting, had withdrawn, the delegation reassembled, and invited Judge Savage and Messrs. Gallagher, Rosewater, Her, Bennett, and others to continue to occupy time. At 11:45 o'clock the meeting was concluded. An agreement was signed that the railroad tax clause should be so amended that the right of way and real estate covered by the tracks be exempted, and that no more amendments be made. A vote of thanks was tendered by the representatives of Omaha, including Judge Savage, Messrs. Yates, Gallagher, (of Pax & Co.), and others. The bill was then recommitted to the committee on the charter, and an expression by them favoring the charter as it will be thus amended and recommending its passage without further amendment.

Proceedings of the Senate.

LINCOLN, Neb., Feb. 8.—[Special Telegram to the Bee.]—The senate had an hour's session this morning. The lobby was stronger than ever, owing to the fact that there were so many important issues coming up for consideration. When the committee on engrossed bills and enrolled bills reported this morning senate bills 29 and 41 were brought up. These bills both provide for the repeal of the railway commission. Mr. Colby moved that the report of the committee with reference to these two bills, be indefinitely postponed.

Mr. Casper strongly objected to the action which designed to kill the bills in the absence of their friends. Mr. Colby replied that he had no objection to the action which he had taken.

Mr. Holmes moved to amend by having the two bills recommitted to the committee on railroads.

Mr. Robinson objected. He did not want to see the bill referred back to the railroad committee. The senate had had a question and shortly previous certain members were absent on account of sickness he did not want to see a dirty trick played upon them.

Mr. Robinson held that it would be disrespectful for the senate to take this action in the absence of Mr. Sterling, who was sick. He wanted the matter to go to where it is and where it is not to be present.

Mr. Lininger moved to make the original matter a special order for Thursday.

Mr. Colby moved to amend by having the bill referred back to the committee on railroads.

Mr. Holmes explained that his intention was to amend by having the bill referred back to the committee on railroads.

Mr. Casper looked with suspicion upon the amendment proposed by Mr. Colby.

Mr. Colby came up again and said that while his motion was to indefinitely postpone, he had accepted the notion to recommit solely because he did not want to see the bill go to where it is and where it is not to be present.

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association urging passage of certain bills were read.

The speaker appointed Messrs. Watson and Thornton additional members of the special committee for investigation of the status of insurance companies. The house then adjourned.

Senator-elect Platt visited the house during the afternoon.

The galleries were filled with a large number of spectators, ladies predominating, during the afternoon.

Seven-tenths of the members of the legislature are so hoarse from colds contracted by exposure to cold winds, that they are unable to make themselves heard ten feet away.

SUTTON SHOOTING SKYWARD.

New Railroad, Telegraph and Telephone Facilities Make a Boom.

SUTTON, Neb., Feb. 8.—[Special Telegram to the Bee.]—The new depot on the Kansas City & Omaha is nearly completed. The telegraph line will reach here tomorrow.

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CHARTERED MONEY SHARKS.

Senator Casper's Argument Before the Joint Legislative Committee on Railroads.

TIME FOR HEROIC MEASURES.

The Financial Porons Plaster That Is Sucking the Life of the Nebraska Farmer—The Argument in Full.

Freight Rates Needed.

LINCOLN, Neb., Feb. 8.—The following argument was presented by Senator Casper of Butler to the meeting of the joint committee on railroads held this evening:

One of the grave mistakes made by the railroad companies themselves, in their efforts to save the legislature, congressional investigating committees, etc., seems to rest in the thought: "How can we prevent injustice being done to the commerce of this country, and yet allow transportation companies to earn dividends on watered stock—or, on a showing of indebtedness that was never honestly created—for vast sums ranging from two to six times more than it ever cost to build and equip the roads that practice these wrongs?"

It is impossible to find a more honest, and apparently fair minded man to pronounce the subject to be one of profound mystery and extreme delicacy, and who finally abandon the subject as a financial puzzle.

They find that protection of the people who have sworn to protect in congress and state legislatures and the national congress, means an upsetting of values, and a disturbance of business. During the whole time these timid conservatives are halting on the ragged edge of impending conflict, the masses of the people are being plundered.

As the subject now stands it is a jugglery of numbers and figures, and which only the thieves and their cohorts have the presumption to deny. While independent industries—apparently small and insignificant—are paralyzed, and labor groans and sweats in the broiling sun, the beneficiaries of these syndicated gangs of chartered money sharks, thrive and grow fat on the bread earned in the sweat of others.

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that which will not only furnish relief, but is easy of interpretation—not liable to cause misunderstandings.

Another point which has been made of calculation endeavor to get a unit of value that has a clear cut and well defined quantity in the mind of every citizen.

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A MOUNTAIN MYSTERY.

The Strange Sight Seen by California Hunters.

Ventura (Cal.) Free Press: Parties returning from hunting trips to the mountains often tell strange tales of their experience when miles away from habitation, of conflicts with grizzly bears, mountain lions, etc., but by far the most weird story we have heard is told by two well-known young men of this place, who were on a prospecting tour some three weeks since near Coboles, one mountain at the northern boundary of this county. The story they tell—and they are willing to take their oath on the truth of the statement—is about as follows:

One cold night they were simultaneously awakened about 12 o'clock by the noise of crackling brush that had been thrown on the fire. They arose to a sitting posture and saw the figure of an Indian woman standing by the fire. She was dressed in a robe of gayly-colored material that almost reached to her feet. A glistening necklace, evidently of gold and silver enriched her neck, and hanging pendant from this were a number of bear's claws. Her black hair reached below her waist. In her ears were large hoop earrings of gold.

Upon seeing the form, one of the young men instinctively reached for his rifle by his side, while the other stared in amazement at seeing such a sight in the dead of the night and thirty miles from any house. When the figure saw the motion made to reach the rifle she motioned for them not to fire and moved down the trail beckoning to them. Before disap-

them not to fire and moved down the trail, beckoning to them. Before disappearing from view she again beckoned to them, but they were too dumfounded to follow.

The next morning they followed the trail, and, after much difficulty, traced the footprints to the base of a high cliff about a mile from their camp. The rest of the story told is to this effect: "When I awoke," said one of the young men, "I was horrified. I couldn't move to save my life. I was frozen with astonishment. The next morning we discussed the matter and determined to investigate. So the next night we took our blankets and went to the base of the cliff. At about midnight, the same hour the figure appeared to us, we saw a bright phosphorescent light on the brow of the cliff, and I am sure we heard a voice calling 'Meeneeah! Meeneeah!' several times. This is the strangest experience I ever passed through. I never have believed in ghosts, but I would like to know what this was. If it was a woman how did she come there at that time, thirty miles from civilization?"

An old Indian tradition is to the effect that many, many years ago an Indian maiden—Meeneeah, the only daughter of a chief—was lost in this region and starved to death near the place called Squaw Falls. It is said that different camping parties have seen the phosphorescent light spoken of in the vicinity where these young men were camped. Can this be a parallel case with that of the Indian woman abandoned on San Nicolas island for eighteen years?